

Between 1963 and 1971 the total urban population increased by 41.3 per cent while the population of those areas which were urban in both 1963 and 1971 (that is excluding areas which gained urban status after 1963) increased by only 21.3 percent. Thus increase of 21.3 percent is only slightly higher than the 19.0 percent intercensal increase of the total population. The share of the combined population of these areas which were categorised as urban in both 1963 and 1971 increased only slightly from 19.0 percent in 1963 to 19.3 percent in 1971. The 19.3 percent increase of the population of those areas which were classified as urban in 1963 is only slightly higher than that of the total population of the country. Thus it may be concluded that about half the growth in the total urban population between 1963 and 1971 was due to the inclusion of new areas to the urban category.

3.6 Districtwise distribution of urban population

The distribution of the urban population by type of Council area and district is shown in Table 3.7. The districts are arranged in descending order of the percentage that the urban population of each district bears to the total urban population of the country. This percentage is given in the last column of the table.

A little more than half (51.8 percent) of the Island's urban population was concentrated in the Colombo district. Another 24 percent resided within the 4 districts of Jaffna, Kalutara, Galle and Kandy. Hence, about three quarters of the total urban population in the Island was distributed in the 5 districts of Colombo, Jaffna, Kalutara, Galle and Kandy. Of the remaining 25 percent about 15 percent was distributed in the 5 districts of Trincomalee, Batticaloa, Matara, Badulla and Puttalam. The other 10 percent was distributed in the remaining 10 districts where the proportion ranged between 1.8 and .02 percent.

3.7 Distribution of urban areas by population size

The distribution of the urban areas by population size as at the census of 1971 is given in the table 3.8

TABLE 3.8 : POPULATION DISTRIBUTION BY TYPE OF URBAN AREA AND SIZE OF POPULATION - 1971

Population Size	M.CC		U.CC		T.CC		TOTAL	
	No.	Popula- tion	No.	Popula- tion	No.	Popula- tion	No.	Popu- lation
Less than 5000	-	-	4	13,161	34	102,554	38	115,715
5000 & less than 10,000	-	-	8	65,468	22	150,389	30	215,857
10,000 & less than 20,000	1	17,288	13	206,055	20	276,218	34	499,551
20,000 & less than 50,000	5	157,232	10	296,464	10	328,178	25	781,874
50,000 & less than 100,000	3	221,364	2	189,947	-	-	5	411,311
100,000 & over	3	823,798	-	-	-	-	3	823,798
Total	12	1219,682	37	771,095	86	857,339	135	2848,116